to give'. This scheme runs once a year. Again, 50 per cent of the money raised in this fashion remains with the district concerned and the remaining 50 per cent goes to the state unit.[25]

'Win a Booth, Win an Election': A Worm's-eye View of the BJP

'Why should I make a WhatsApp group of karyakartas?' shouted the angry BJP booth president on the phone. A BJP call centre had contacted him. It was a follow-up call to check whether he had actually completed the work that his boss, the area's district chief, had earlier reported as concluded to his higher-ups: the making of WhatsApp groups of all party workers at the voting-booth level.

When the party's call-centre worker insisted on an answer, the booth president exploded in anger. He added his own complaints: 'After three years you have remembered us. For three years our members' work is pending. One drain could not be made in our gali [street] in three years and ten houses are in water. With what face will I go in the gali to ask votes for someone. The public gives us *gandi gandi gaali* [dirty abuses].'

'I understand, I understand,' the other man, himself a party worker, kept repeating helplessly, in the way that call centre helpline personnel often do, even as the local leader's anger washed over him.

This recording was played for me by the booth worker's district party leader. I was quizzing him on the role of WhatsApp in party management. He responded by saying, 'Let me show you something I should not be showing you. It is against me, but let me make you hear it.' With that, he played this recording on his phone. It had been WhatsApped to him, he said, by the party's IT Cell. They informed him of the problem they had identified at the booth level in his area, asked why he wasn't aware of it and asked him to solve it.

The recording reflected a new layer in the multiple management-oversight systems the BJP had put in place in UP: random checks on the work of the lowest-level members and their performance through a centralised state call centre that had the numbers of all workers across all levels. 'They connected from there [Lucknow] and sent it to me. Our work is to make lists [of party